The use cases of blockchain are particularly interesting

We are given an idea of how this technology can be used in border control (pg 735), elections, and citizen identification (pg 737). Links are given to show how the technology is being used already — blockchain audited presidential vote in Sierra Leone, and in the city of Zug in Switzerland.

In elections, blockchain helps reduce vulnerabilities. This comes by way of end-to-end security and transparency in the process. The immutability it offers ensures that votes cast once cannot be cast again. A smart contract can maintain a list of already-cast votes with biometric IDs. Zero-knowledge proofs (ZKPs) can be used on the blockchain to protect voters' privacy.

Blockchain can help with citizen identification, and with digital identities on social networks and forums too. Users can see who has used their data and for what purpose, and control access to it. Healthcare could benefit majorly, as blockchain can offer an "immutable, auditable, and transparent system that traditional P2P networks cannot." It can also help to detect the sale of counterfeit medicines.

Lack of interoperability compromises privacy, and leads to data breaches, high costs and fraud. Blockchain can help, we're told, with media issues like content distribution, rights management, and royalty payments to artists. Take the example of Musicoin *(https://musicoin.org)*, which seems almost too good to be true. Their website promises (this is not part of the book): "Musicoin is a music streaming platform built on the blockchain that supports the creation, distribution and consumption of music in a shared economy. Listeners can stream songs from independent musicians on our platform absolutely free and without ads, while musicians are compensated more fairly than major music streaming platforms in the industry."

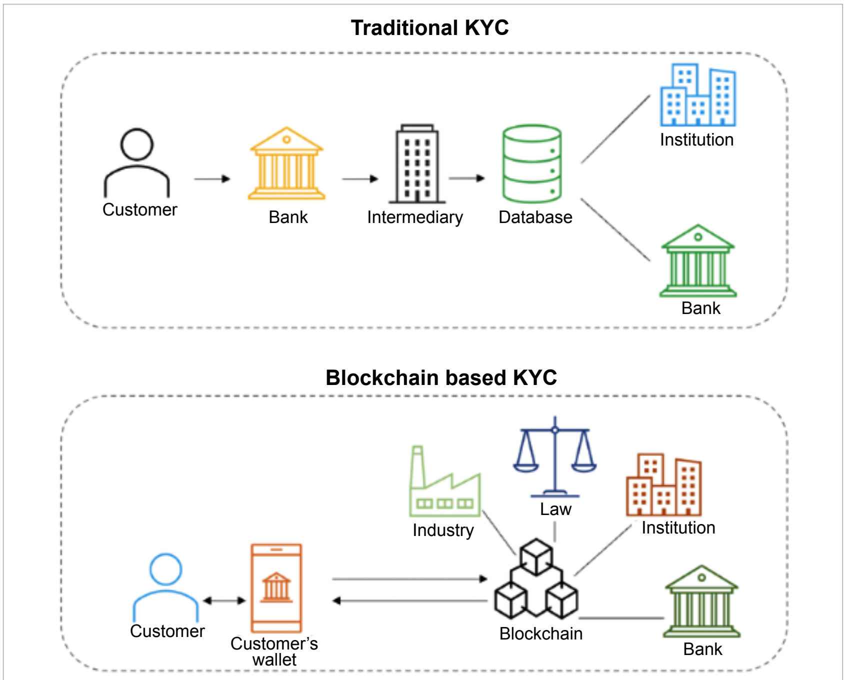
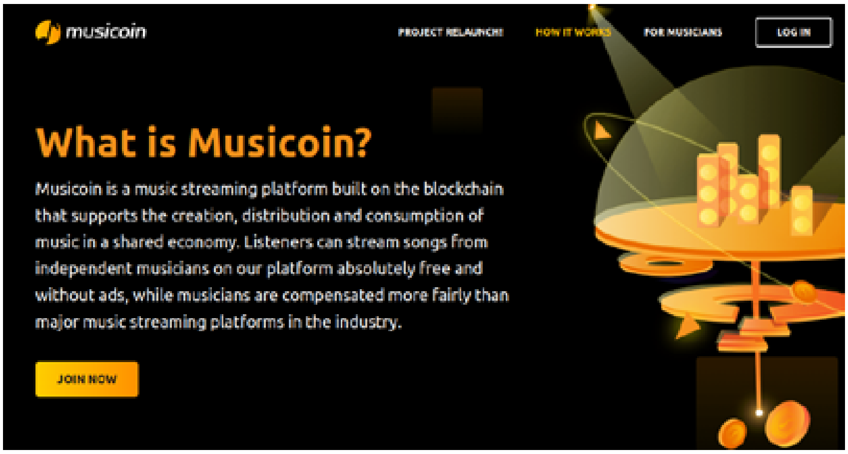


Figure 21.2: Traditional vs blockchain-based KYC



Chapter 21 looks at how decentralised finance can work in various financial fields such as trading, exchanges, post-trade settlement, and financial crime prevention.

The book is supplemented with example code files on GitHub. Readers can also download a PDF file with colour images of screenshots and diagrams used in the book (see *https://packt.link/5y4vk).*

Like with other books from this publisher, this one too invites feedback.

If blockchain is your thing, go for it. This book could surely help those who want to delve deeper into the field. END

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